

COGNITIVE BEHAVIORAL THERAPY (CBT) – SESSION 8

New Case: Rohan (26 y/o) – Contamination OCD + Checking
Highly Detailed – Realistic Style

SESSION INFORMATION

Client:	Rohan (26 years, Male, Software Engineer, Bangalore)	Therapist:	Dr. A.
Session #:	8 of 18–20	Focus:	Continuing ERP + Reviewing Progress

PRE-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

Client arrived looking more confident and noticeably less ashamed than earlier sessions. He practiced the lift button exposure at home 3 times with good habituation on most attempts. He reported that anxiety is decreasing faster with repeated practice. He continues to use labeling and is delaying other compulsions more consistently. Today's plan: Review home ERP practice in detail, continue ERP with the next hierarchy item (shaking hands with a colleague and delaying washing), reinforce progress and coping skills, and assign new homework. Maintain supportive and encouraging approach.

SESSION START – HOMEWORK REVIEW

Therapist: Good morning, Rohan. How has your week been? I'm curious to hear how the lift button practice at home went.

Client: (speaking with more confidence) It went quite well. I practiced it three times. The first time, anxiety went up to around 50 and took about 8–9 minutes to come down. By the third time, it only went up to around 35–40 and came down faster — in about 5–6 minutes. I was able to delay washing significantly each time. I also noticed that on days when I used labeling quickly, it was easier to manage other urges too. I still washed more than I ideally want to, but I'm delaying much more often now.

Therapist: That's excellent progress. You're clearly experiencing faster habituation with repeated practice — the anxiety is rising less and coming down quicker. This is exactly how ERP works over time. You're also generalizing the labeling skill to other situations. How are you feeling about these changes?

Client: I feel more hopeful and a bit proud. I didn't think I could handle touching things like lift buttons without washing immediately. Seeing that I can delay and that the anxiety comes down has made me feel more in control. I'm still nervous about some of the higher items on the list, but I think I can keep going.

CONTINUING ERP – NEXT HIERARCHY ITEM

Therapist: Since you're making good progress, I'd like to suggest we move to the next item on your hierarchy today in session — shaking hands with me (as a stand-in for a colleague) and then delaying washing for a longer period (aiming for 10+ minutes). We can practice it here first. How does that sound?

Client: I think I can try that. It feels a bit more real because it involves another person, but I'm more confident after the last few practices.

Therapist: That's completely understandable. Let's do it step by step. I'll extend my hand, and you can shake it. Then we'll stay with whatever thoughts and anxiety come up, using labeling and breathing. We'll aim to delay washing for at least 10 minutes. Ready when you are.

(In-session exposure conducted: Rohan shook hands with the therapist. Initial anxiety rose to around 55/100 with strong urge to wash. He practiced labeling and breathing. After 11 minutes, anxiety decreased to around 18/100. He reported that the urge weakened significantly over time. Post-exposure processing done.)

Therapist: How was that experience for you?

Client: It was harder than the lift button, but I could handle it. The anxiety went up more, especially right after shaking hands, but it still came down after some time. I feel tired now, but also relieved and a bit proud that I was able to wait without washing immediately.

Therapist: That's a significant step. You tolerated higher anxiety and still experienced strong habituation. This builds real confidence that you can handle more difficult real-life situations. How are you feeling about practicing this one at home?

Client: I think I can try it 2–3 times this week, maybe by shaking hands with a colleague I trust or practicing with a friend. I'm still nervous, but today's practice helped a lot.

HOMEWORK ASSIGNMENT

Therapist: For this week:

1. Practice shaking hands (with a trusted colleague or friend) and delaying washing for 10+ minutes (2–3 times)
2. Continue practicing the lift button exposure at home
3. Continue labeling and monitoring

Client: I'll try the shaking hands one. I feel more prepared after today's session.

Therapist: Excellent. We'll review how it went next session.

SESSION SUMMARY & FEEDBACK

Therapist: Today we reviewed your strong progress at home, did the next hierarchy item in session (shaking hands), and saw excellent habituation. How are you feeling about today's session?

Client: I feel more confident than before. Each exposure is getting a bit easier, and I'm seeing that I can handle more than I thought. I'm still scared of some higher items, but I think I can keep going.

Therapist: That's wonderful to hear. Any questions before we finish?

Client: Not really.

POST-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

- Client showed continued strong progress in ERP. Successfully completed fourth hierarchy item in session with excellent habituation.
- Client reported increased confidence and generalization of coping skills (labeling helping with other urges).
- Motivation and engagement remain high. Client is gradually building tolerance to higher anxiety levels.
- Next session: Review home ERP practice (shaking hands), continue ERP with next hierarchy item if ready, reinforce coping skills and self-compassion, address any emerging difficulties.

Disclaimer: This is a completely fictional but realistic simulation created solely for educational and AI training purposes. It does not represent any real person or therapy.